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(54) **STRAWBERRY PLANT NAMED ‘TAIA’**

(50) Latin Name: *Fragaria*×*ananassa*
Varietal Denomination: **Taia**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

The present invention provides a new and distinct strawberry plant designated as ‘Taia’ (a.k.a. ‘108825’).

5 Drawing Sheets

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Latin name of the genus and species: *Fragaria*×*ananassa*.
Varietal denominations: ‘Taia’ (a.k.a. ‘108825’).

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct strawberry variety designated as ‘Taia’ (a.k.a. ‘108825’).

‘Taia’ (a.k.a. ‘108825’) is the result of a controlled-cross between a female parent cultivar designated 106734 and a male parent cultivar designated 103474 (both unpatented, proprietary cultivars) made by the Inventor and was first fruited in Watsonville, Calif. growing fields. Following selection and during testing, the plant was originally designated ‘108825’ and subsequently named ‘Taia’.

This new variety was asexually reproduced via runners (stolons) by the inventor at Watsonville, Calif. Asexual propagules from the original source have been tested in Watsonville growing fields and to a limited extent, grower fields in high elevation. The properties of this variety were found to be transmissible by such asexual reproduction. This cultivar is stable and reproduces true to type in successive generations of asexual reproduction.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

This invention relates to a new and distinctive strawberry cultivar designated as ‘Taia’. These cultivars are primarily adapted to the climate and growing conditions of the central coast of California. This region provides the necessary temperatures required for it to produce a strong vigorous plant and to remain in fruit production from March through October. The nearby Pacific Ocean provides the needed humidity and moderate day temperatures and evening chilling to maintain fruit quality for the production months.

The following traits and photographs in combination distinguish strawberry variety ‘Taia’ from known strawberry varieties. In addition, this new cultivar was confirmed to be a unique strawberry germplasm when tested against the California Seed & Plant Lab, Inc. (Elverta, Calif.) database using Short Sequence Repeats (SSRs). Plants for the botani-

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cal measurements in the present application were grown as annuals. Any color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 1995 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used. The fruit produced by this new cultivar is attractive and of excellent quality.

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The accompanying color photographs depict various characteristics of the cultivars as nearly true as possible to make color reproductions.

FIG. 1 shows ‘Taia’ plants with ripe and near-ripe fruits.

FIG. 2 shows a close-up look of ‘Taia’ plants in the field with near-ripe fruits, showing the details of the flowers, leaves and petiole.

FIG. 3 shows ‘Taia’ plant leaves with petioles.

FIG. 4 shows a close-up look of a ‘Taia’ plant leaf.

FIG. 5 shows flower petals and sepals of ‘Taia’ plant.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

‘Taia’ (a.k.a. ‘108825’)

This invention relates to a new and distinctive day-neutral type cultivar designated as ‘Taia’. It is primarily adapted to the climate and growing conditions of the central coast of California. This region provides the necessary temperatures required for it to produce a strong vigorous plant and to remain in fruit production from March through October. The nearby Pacific Ocean provides the needed humidity and moderate day temperatures and evening chilling to maintain fruit quality for the production months.

The following traits in combination distinguish strawberry variety ‘Taia’ from the known strawberry varieties. Plants for the botanical measurements in the present application were grown as annuals. In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 1995 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

‘Taia’ has not been observed under all possible environmental conditions, and the phenotype may vary significantly with variations in environment. The following observations, measurements, and comparisons describe this plant as grown under normal conditions in Watsonville, Calif. unless otherwise noted.

Hybrid Patent Data Sheet (planted: October Year 1; measurement: November Year 2) ‘Taia’ (a.k.a. ‘108825’)	
Plant	
Plant Growth Habit	semi-upright
Day length	neutral
Plant season	fall
Height (mm)	370
Diameter (mm)	435 (the entire plant structure, including the “superstructure” of petioles, leaves, flowers) 70 (inner “base” or “heart” structure of the plant, i.e. the mature apical and axial crowns of the strawberry plant where petioles, flowers and runners are attached)
Density of foliage	medium
Average number of crowns per mature plant	3
Plant vigor	moderate
Rain/weather tolerance	moderate
Harvest ease	moderate
Terminal Leaf	
Length (mm)	67
Width (mm)	84
Terminal leaflet	1.25
length/width ratio	
Blistering	none
No. teach/terminal leaflet	26
Shape of terminal leaflet	obtuse
base	
Shape of terminal leaflet in cross-section	concave
Margin description of the terminal	serrate to crenate
Shape of teeth	obtuse
Color of upper side of leaves	137A
Color of lower side of leaves	137C
Leaf glossiness	medium to weak
presence or absence of any leaf variegation	absence
Number of leaflets	35
Terminal leaflet margin	revolute
Terminal leaflet shape	orbicular
Terminal Leaflet shape of apex	obtuse/conical
Petiole	
Length (mm)	355
Width (mm)	3.5
Petiole pubescence	medium
Petiole pose of hairs	outwards
Petiole color	145A
Petiolule	
Length (mm)	21
Width(mm)	1.8
Stolon	
Count (mm)	325
Diameter (mm)	5
Stolon number	12
Description of any anthocyanin coloration	172A
Density of pubescence on the stolon	medium
Stolon thickness	small
Stolon pubescence	medium

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Hybrid Patent Data Sheet (planted: October Year 1; measurement: November Year 2) ‘Taia’ (a.k.a. ‘108825’)	
5	
	Stolon color 146C
	Inflorescence
	Petal/flower
	Corolla diameter (mm) 22
10	Calyx diameter (mm) 26
	Color of calyx 136A
	Pose of calyx segments reflexed
	Size of calyx in relation to fruit smaller
	Position of calyx inserted
15	attachment
	Level of adherence of calyx Medium to high
	Petal length (mm) 15
	Petal width (mm) 16
	Petal length/width ratio 0.938
	Petal shape orbicular
20	Petal apex rounded
	Petal margin entire
	Petal base shape concave
	Petal spacing touching
	Petal number per flower 5
	Upper petal color N999D
25	Lower petal color 155C
	Sepal length (mm) 11
	Sepal width (mm) 5
	Sepal number per flower 12
	Sepal shape elliptical
	Sepal apex convex
	Sepal margin entire
30	Peduncle size (cm) 26.5
	Stipules length (mm) 37
	Stipules width (mm) 7
	Stipule pubescence medium
	Stipule anthocyanin absence
	Stipule color 145B
35	Inflorescence position relative to foliage even
	flower arrangement of petals touching
	Number of flowers per plant 24
40	Flower size large
	Number of stamen 30-35
	Receptacle color 150B
	Anther color 12A
	Fertility self-fertile
	Time of flowering March
45	Fruit
	Fruit/truss 5
	Length (mm) 44
	Width (mm) 38
	Fruit length/width ratio 1.1
	Core length (mm) 35
50	Core width (mm) 14
	Fruiting truss length (mm) 98
	Fruiting truss diameter (mm) 2
	Truss color 145B
	Fruit skin color 41A
55	Fruit weight (g) 26
	Relative fruit size large
	Predominant fruit shape conical
	Difference in shape between primary & secondary fruits none to very slight
60	Glossiness medium
	Position of achenes even
	Achene color 145A
	Achenes per fruit 127
	Achene weight (g) 0.09
	Width of the band without achenes low to medium
65	

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Hybrid Patent Data Sheet	
(planted: October Year 1; measurement: November Year 2)	
‘Taia’ (a.k.a. ‘108825’)	
Firmness of flesh	medium to firm
Color of flesh	41A
Time of fruit ripening	April
Harvest maturity (50% of plants with ripe fruit)	early
Grams of fruit/plat (during peak season, June)	662
Appearance Score (from 1-5, with 5 = best)	4
Storage longevity (e.g., 10 days to 2 weeks)	7 to 10 days
Cull rate: Non salable fruit production rate	<15%
Disease and pest resistance	not tested
Acidity as measured by pH	3.26
Sweetness as measured by brix	6.3

When ‘Taia’ is compared to the proprietary female parent, ‘Taia’ has a smaller calyx diameter and a smaller corolla diameter. In addition, the number of fruit per truss of ‘Taia’ is fewer than that of the female parent.

When ‘Taia’ is compared to the proprietary male parent, ‘Taia’ has a medium density of foliage, while the male parent has a high density of foliage. The plant vigor of ‘Taia’ is moderate, while the plant vigor of the male parent is high. The terminal leaflet margin of ‘Taia’ is revolute, while the terminal leaflet margin of the male parent is flat.

When ‘Taia’ is compared to ‘Seascape’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 7,614), the terminal leaf of ‘Taia’ has a serrate to crenate margin, while the terminal leaf of ‘Seascape’ has a crenate margin. The leaf glossiness of ‘Taia’ ranges from medium to weak, while the leaf glossiness of ‘Seascape’ is medium. The number of leaflets of ‘Taia’ is 35, while the number of leaflets of ‘Seascape’ is 49.

The invention claimed is:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of strawberry plant named ‘Taia’ substantially as shown and described herein.

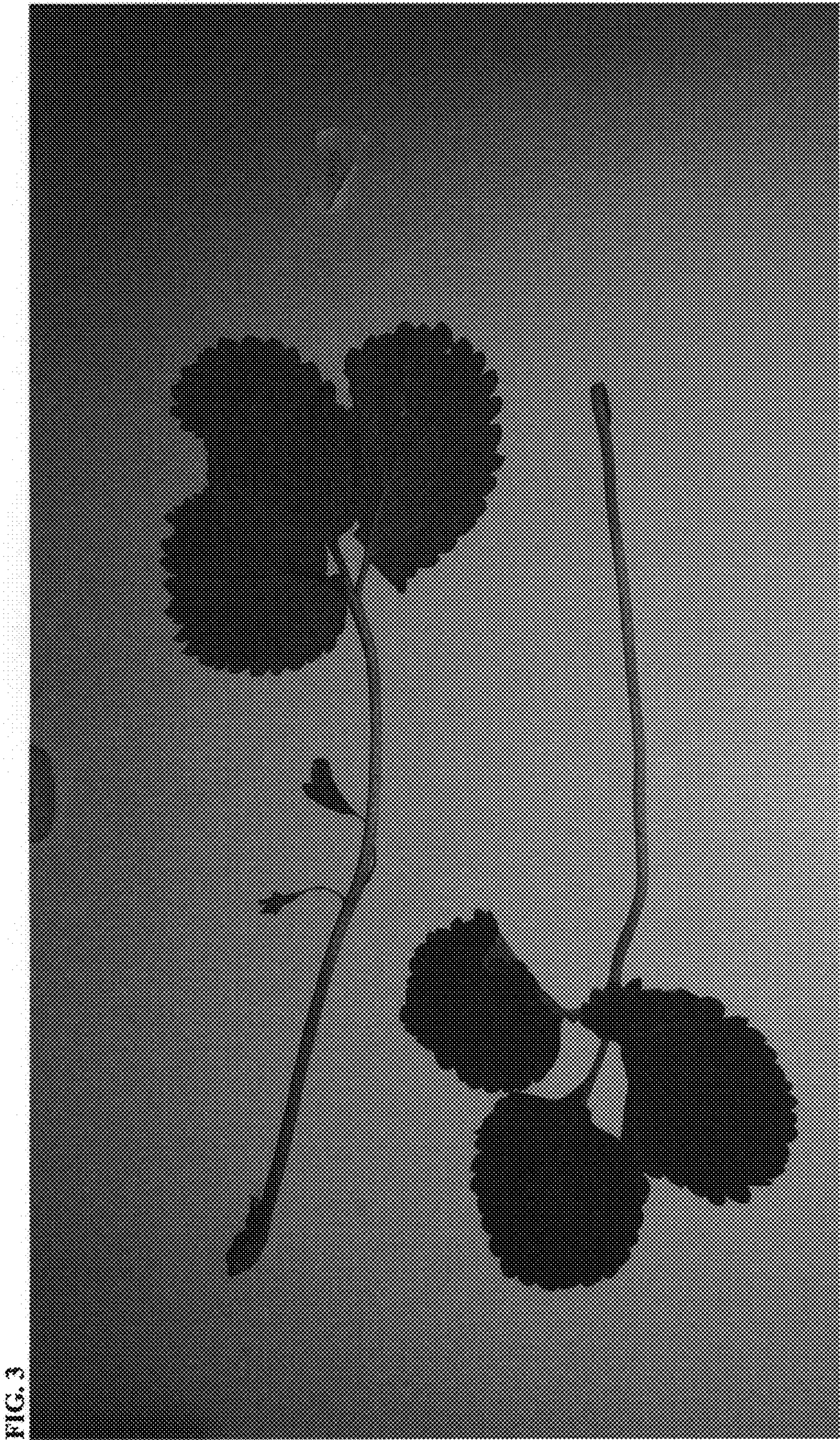
* * * * *

FIG. 1





FIG. 2.



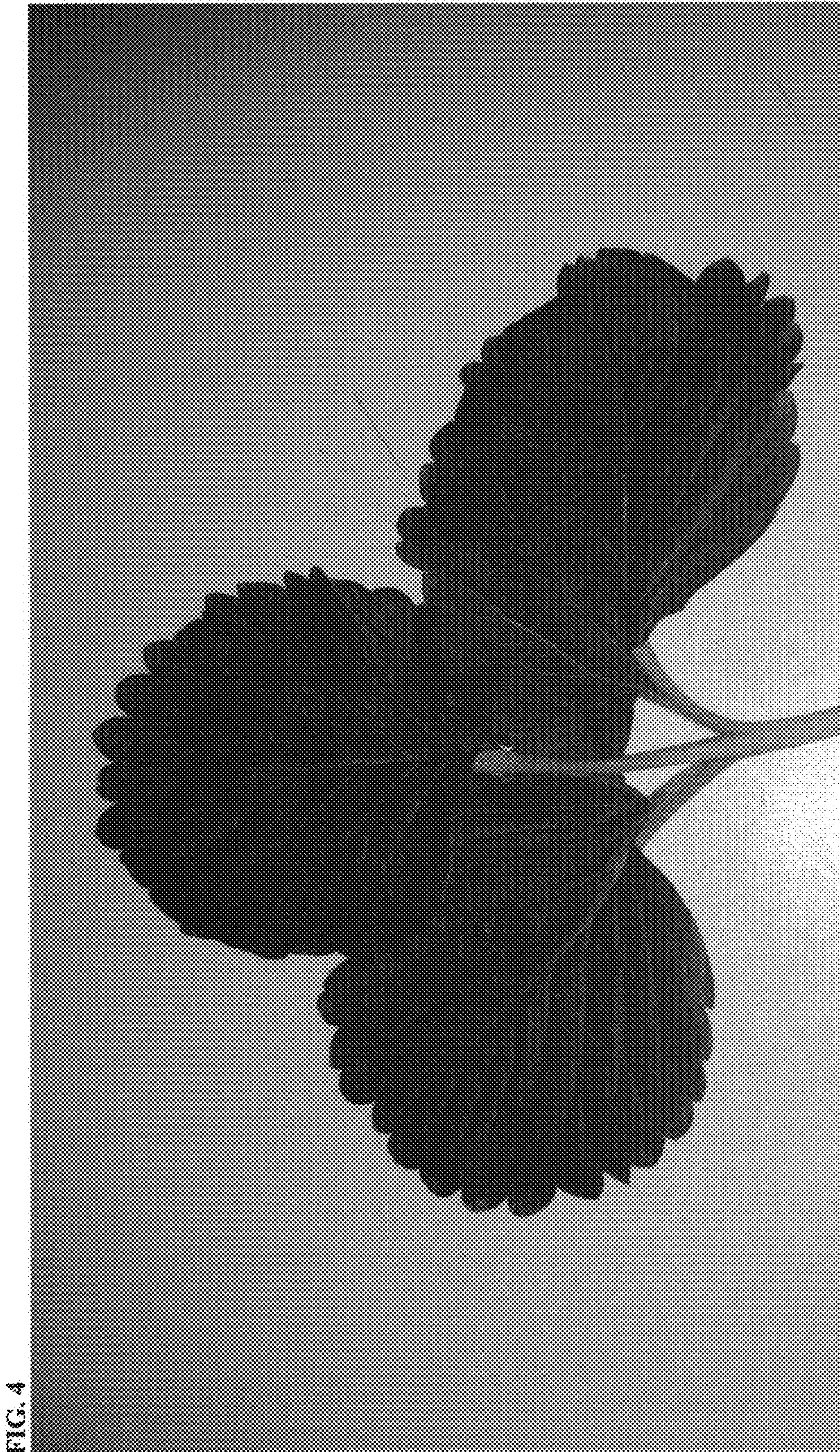


FIG. 4



FIG. 5